through simplistic propositions. As we are increasingly discovering, one truth mainly works for one street.

The quest to develop capacities clearly benefits from domestic reform and modernization initiatives. This linkage was dumbed down to the assertion that 8 per cent growth was the best foreign policy! The reality, however, is that growth gained without transforming the foundations and framework had in-built limitations. This decade has consequently been a much more comprehensive effort that departed from established mantras. It also sought to avoid the pitfalls that were presented by a less strategic understanding of globalization. India's decision not to accede to the RCEP agreement in 2019 was significant in that respect. One important indication of the changed approach was in its very conceptualization. For the first time, Indian policymakers started framing the rise of India in terms of an era that is called the *Amrit Kaal*. By doing so, they articulate a thinking that is more long-term, comprehensive and transformational. And the fact is that the achievements of the last decade justify such a view point.

There is no shortage of indices that would point to the progress of recent years. And these do not in any way deny the magnitude of challenges that still confront India. But among them, perhaps it is worth focussing on those that are directly relevant to India's rise in the international system. A starting point is the steep decline in poverty, notable not only because it is among the more extreme problems facing India but also as it represents a wider drag on society. Equally important is the Indian middle class, which is expected to double during the *Amrit Kaal*, that is, by 2047. The world is surely assessing these developments, both from contribution and consumption perspectives. As it studies the quality of India's human resources, it would also note major expansion of universities, medical and nursing colleges and engineering and technical skills. Indeed, there is a change underway in the approaches to education and skill development that are designed to make them more world-friendly. The transformation in infrastructure is also underway, reflected in expansion of highways, railways, airports and digital networks. India is no longer seen as just limited to services. Even at home, energetic digital delivery has revolutionized governance and helped prepare the ground for deeper participation in a range of domains.

By raising the definition of basic amenities and, more importantly, delivering on them, India is rapidly changing the quality of life of one-sixth